

EP24: Some Restrictions Apply: The Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the Domination System

Steven T. Newcomb and Peter d'Errico · AI-generated transcript · 2026

[Peter] (0:02 - 0:48)

Good morning, Steve. Good to see you.

[Steve] Yeah. Good seeing you. Likewise.

[Peter] So today, we agreed we'd talk about a topic you brought up actually several weeks ago, the United Nations, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

And what I'm particularly interested in is the difference that you pointed out to me when we first started thinking we ought to talk about it between the first draft in 1947 and the final draft in 1948 around whether or not there's such a thing as a right to resist tyranny. And if so, what is the business about what are human rights for if they're not to protect against tyranny, etc. So maybe you just dive in how you came to that awareness and where we'll go from there.

[Steve] (0:49 - 4:47)

Well, a few years ago, I think it was 2023, Shauna and I went to, my daughter Shauna and I went to the Parliament of World Religions in Chicago. And there was a panel discussion on the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. The theme of the event was human rights overall.

And when I got into the into the room where the panel discussion was going to take place, I thought, well, let me look up the document. And when I did, my eye fell on the third preamble paragraph, which just to paraphrase it a bit, because kind of clunky language in there, but it says that the human rights should be enshrined or established in the rule of law, so that man will not be compelled in the last resort to rebel against tyranny and oppression. And I thought that was pretty significant, considering the domination system and all that we talk about, well, tyranny and oppression are two synonyms for domination.

So right there, it's very obvious. When I tried to bring that to the attention of the panelists after they had made their presentation, they kind of were very dismissive. It had no real significance to them.

So that's just to tell you how I stumbled upon all this. A couple of months ago, I thought, I wonder if there was any prior discussion about that preamble paragraph, or if that preamble paragraph appeared in an earlier draft of the document. So I decided to search for that.

And, by the way, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights was adopted on December 10th of 1948. When I did look for that, I found a draft version from June 4th of 1947. And there was no preamble at all, so no preamble paragraph.

But I decided, well, let me read the whole document. When I got to Article 29, it was very interesting, because it said that everyone, individually or with others, has the right to resist oppression and tyranny. And I thought, well, that's pretty interesting.

That's pretty straightforward. You have the right to resist domination, in other words. That's how I interpret it.

And then I looked at the completed document, and Article 29 was clunked up with a whole bunch of convoluted language about other things, and some of it really all twisted up. The point I'm making here is that there was a discussion, obviously, going on among the drafters of the document about these types of issues. And what is the significance of that in terms of what is the meaning of human to begin with?

How do we understand that word in the context of this type of a document, in the context of a discussion of human rights? Why is there a need for human rights to begin with? Well, because of oppression and tyranny, or they flipped it in the preamble to tyranny and oppression.

But obviously, domination is a central feature of the whole discussion. It should be. But they're not using domination.

They do use it in some of the colonial documents later on in the 60s, and the move toward independence for colonial peoples, as they put it. But in any case, in this particular phase of the discussion, I thought that that was pretty darn significant language. So that's kind of an intro to our discussion.

[Peter] (4:47 - 8:16)

Well, yeah, I'm going to read the language that you're referring to. The original, the first draft, Article 29, is very straightforward. It's one sentence.

It says, everyone has the right, either individually or with others, to resist oppression and tyranny. Now, as you say, obviously, they were talking about oppression and tyranny, or in other words, domination, and they were talking about that there's a right to resist domination. There's a right to resist tyranny.

There's a right to resist being subjugated by some powers. Now, that provoked further discussion, obviously, because a year later, a little over a year later, they come out with a document that does not say that there's a right to resist tyranny and oppression, but it says that it's a kind of a whereas clause, as you pointed out in the preamble. It says, whereas it is essential if man is not to be compelled to have recourse as a last resort to rebellion against tyranny and oppression, that human rights should be protected by the rule of law.

What actually are they saying there? The first one said, very simply, there's a right to resist tyranny and oppression. The second one says that, oh, so that people don't have to rebel against it, there have to be human rights.

So somewhere in that discussion was an assumption that if there's something called human rights, then there's no right to resist tyranny and oppression. You simply go and claim your

human right against tyranny and oppression. And it seems to me that it's getting, as you said, it's convoluted.

It's also sort of, it's like waving a little bit of a rhetorical wand and saying, well, we're still talking about tyranny and oppression, but we're not saying there's a right to resist it. We're just saying that it's the reason why we have human rights, so now you don't have to resist it. If you have human rights, you don't have to resist it.

So you don't even get to the question whether you have a right to resist it. And I think that in all of that, we see a certain depth of confusion, but I'm thinking maybe it's not confusion, it's actually intentional manipulation of concepts that says that in this time of the UN Universal Declaration, that somehow it has superseded a right to resist, that now we have a mechanism. Now, if you think that there's tyranny and oppression, you go to some tribunal somewhere and you say, oh, there's tyranny and oppression against me.

And it's only if all of that fails that then you have recourse as a last resort, quote unquote, to rebellion. And I think that the whole thing, the whole concept of what does a person have as a fundamental stance in the world, stance to resist tyranny, that's all been gobbled up and cannibalized in institutional procedures here. So you have a complaint, you take it to the proper agency and they have their proper deliberations and so on and so forth.

And only if all that fails, then you might be compelled as a last resort to resist it. Does that seem fair?

[Steve] (8:17 - 9:37)

Sure. Well, I think it would be helpful to folks listening to this podcast to hear how the Article 29 language changed from that very straightforward sentence that you just read to the final outcome. Let me just read that.

There's three sentences or three sections. Everyone has duties to the community in which alone the free and full development of his personality is possible. That's number one.

Number two, in the exercise of his rights and freedoms, everyone shall be subject only to such limitations as are determined by law solely for the purpose of securing due recognition and respect for the rights and freedoms of others and of meeting the just requirements of morality, public order, and the general welfare in a democratic society. Number three, these rights and freedoms may in no case be exercised contrary to the purposes and principles of the United Nations. So all that took the place of that straightforward sentence saying basically everyone individually or with others has the right to resist oppression and tyranny.

[Peter] (9:37 - 10:25)

Yeah. So what happened was the concept that was put forward by the initial drafters in 1947 that there's a fundamental right to resist gets turned into a kind of a complaint system. And there's a complaint desk, and you can take a number and wait in line to voice your complaint.

But always keeping in mind in the final draft that you have a duty to the community. You have a duty to obey. You have a duty.

So suddenly, rather than a right to resist tyranny, there's somehow a duty to obey and to follow procedures. And that's such a fundamental reworking that the right to resist is just a fundamental assertion basically disappears in the document.

[Steve] (10:25 - 11:16)

Well, it's obfuscated completely. And your human rights, your rights and freedoms will only be limited if there's a need based on morality, public order, and the general welfare in a democratic society. And then number three, no one has the right to question the existence of a state of domination, and my add on there, or the territorial integrity of a state.

So that's the contrary to the purposes and principles of the UN, you don't have a right to resist because your right to resist is trumped by the purposes and principles of the United Nations based upon what I just said.

[Peter] (11:16 - 13:07)

Yeah, which means just to slightly change what you just said, your right to resist is changed by the creation of something called human rights. So the thing called human rights has gobbled up and digested the right to resist. So what is your human right?

Oh, my human right is to follow all these rules. And at some point, maybe eventually as a last resort, I can rebel. But that's quite different from saying I have from the outset a right to resist tyranny.

And when you think about the history of these entities, the United States and France in particular, who were instrumental, the original draft is only in English and French, that you have the American Revolution, and you have the French Revolution. And both of those were premised on a right to resist. They were not premised on, now there's an agency you go to if you feel like that the king has done something that's oppressive to you, you go to the king's agencies and you follow the king's procedures.

The French Revolution simply tossed all the king's situation aside, and so did the American Revolution. So the deep history, it's not all that deep, it's just a couple of centuries, the deep history of the two drafting partner languages, English and French, both have in their own past, a simple assertion of a right to resist. That was the end of the story.

So now we're in a situation in which that has, even though it's part of the organic background of these nations, their assertion of the right to resist, it disappears inside their own now present claims of their right to exist.

[Steve] (13:08 - 14:20)

Yeah. Well, and also elsewhere in the document, as I recall, I don't have it memorized, but the right to petition the government is included in here in the final version. But also, there are some areas that allude to or reference domination.

So everyone has the right to life, liberty, and the security of person. Okay, that's great. But then here comes the domination.

No one shall be held in slavery or servitude. Slavery and the slave trade shall be prohibited in all their forms. Number five, article five, no one shall be subjected to torture or to cruel inhuman or degrading treatment or punishment.

And everyone has the right to recognition and everywhere as a person before the law. So these are ways in which they acknowledge the domination, but they don't name it as domination, and they kind of talk around it a bit.

[Peter] (14:22 - 14:39)

So the domination, if we want to just use that word now, the domination system creates a document that says, now if the domination gets too bad, the dominators have a procedure by which you are supposed to complain about it.

[Steve] (14:40 - 16:18)

Well, also, they're referencing, they're using terms that identify the domination without calling it domination. And I already read some of those. Here are some more.

Everyone has the right to an effective remedy by the competent and national tribunals for acts violating the fundamental rights granted him by the constitution or by law. Okay, but these violations of fundamental rights lead toward a reference to domination, if you walk down that track, right? Then Article 9, no one shall be subjected to arbitrary arrest, detention, or exile instances of domination.

And then you also have the, you're entitled to full equality to a fair and public hearing by an independent and impartial tribunal in the determination of rights and obligations and of any criminal charges against someone. And then you're to be presumed innocent until proved guilty. These are things that no one would object to, I think.

But once again, why do you need that in there? Because there are instances in which the domination system will just presume you guilty, and you have to prove your innocence, right? And rather than the state proving you to be guilty beyond a reasonable doubt.

So there's all that in here.

[Peter] (16:20 - 23:01)

And again, you referred to the document talking about a tribunal. So the tribunal is an apparatus of the state system, which is the system that the person who's complaining is actually complaining about. Yeah.

It says an independent tribunal, independent of what? What is a tribunal supposed to be independent of? It can't be independent of the state itself, because that's a contradiction in terms.

Otherwise, it's not a tribunal. So it's a hall of mirrors. I want to jump a little bit.

We've both talked about the extent to which all of the concepts that we're talking about, whether they're the state, rights, human, person, these are ideas. We talk about them as if there's some physical reality. And so it seems to me that if we slow down a little bit, we say, well, what is a right anyway?

What does that mean? What is a right? People say, that's my right.

Well, it's been said before that a right, I think it was Justice Holmes said this, the right is the hypothesis of a prophecy. It's just a reification of a prophecy. What's a prophecy?

It's a prophecy that a court will rule in your favor if you complain. So you say, well, what's my right? My right is I'm prophesying that if I go before this tribunal, the tribunal will say, you're right, and you have this right.

So it doesn't exist outside the framework of the tribunal. It's a concept. It's an idea.

And the state itself, you say, well, what do you mean by the state? People use that term all the time. The state, state property, state department of fill in the blank.

And you've talked about the state of domination, but even shrinking it further than that, the state is an idea form. And it's projected outward into physical objects, like here's a fence and it says state property. OK?

So the property, you say, well, I can see there's dirt over there. There's ground. I see the fence.

But what is this thing called the state? It's a bureaucratic apparatus. Well, what does that mean?

That means that there are some words somewhere, probably in some book somewhere called the Code of Laws. And so what is all that? That's more ideas.

So we never really leave the realm of ideas. And I was rereading Calvin's case recently, which was in the news a little bit because of the birthright case. But it's not so much about the birthright that I was looking at.

It was the concept of allegiance to the king. And it's straight out. It's 1608.

It's straight out of the time of feudalism, which was all a network of personal relationships. And the high court judges, basically all the judges in England were involved in the Calvin's case. And they said, let me see if I can find this quote real quick.

Here it is, talking about allegiance, like allegiance. It says, the qualities of the mind and soul of man and cannot be circumscribed within the predicament of ubi. Ubi is Latin, meaning where.

So if you say, well, where is the state? That's a nonsense question. The high court judges declared it's not.

The allegiance is not to something called England. It's not even to something called the crown. It's to the person of the king, in this case, James, King James.

So it's a network of personal relations. And if a peasant says, my liege, Lord, and the Lord says, you are my liege, man, they're talking about a personal relationship. And that personal relationship is something different from the concept of the state or the concept of lordship.

But I want to say that it's also, it means that it exists in their minds. This personal relationship exists in their minds. It's a mental relationship between people.

And it was manifested in behavior around the king, for example. In the presence of the king, one had to go down on a knee. There had to be a physical, bodily enactment of the idea of liege lord.

And so we have the state today. We say, well, what is the state? Well, it's an abstraction.

It's an idea. But in relation to that abstract idea, we realize what it means is that there are persons who embody that. There are bureaucratic administrators who say they are the CDC, they are the FDA, they are the president, they are the Senate, et cetera, up and down the whole chain of command.

There are people who are playing the role of the representatives of the state. Now, in this society today, the US, we don't think that we're doing personal homage. We don't think I am doing homage to my senator.

I go down on one knee. But what we have is the remnant of it is that that person of the senator, just to use that example, claims to be the representative of this thing that is only an idea called the state. So I'm not sure how coherent I'm being right now, but I'm just trying to tease out the extent to which we're operating in a whole mental world all the time.

And it's sort of like Shakespeare said, all the world's a stage and all the men and women merely players on it. So if you say, OK, say Shakespeare wrote a play about Richard II, let's say. And so where does that play exist?

You say, where? I don't know. What does it mean, where?

It exists. I mean, you can say there's words on a paper, but where is the play itself? Well, it can be enacted and put on the stage.

But where is it comes out of the mind of Shakespeare? Well, what did Shakespeare do with his mind? He looked around him and he saw the plays that were being enacted.

He saw the behaviors being enacted. So he wrote them down and he played with them a little bit to make stories out of them. And so I think that we're in that framework now where people are arguing about political concepts that they take to be some part of reality, but they're really part of a mental world.

And I'm not sure that we're really capable of grappling with that. What does that mean, the mental world?

[Steve] (23:01 - 27:31)

I think raising the question at all or focusing attention on the mental aspect of what we're discussing, the extent to which these things are constructs, creations of the human mind. But

there are also human minds that are in human bodies. So there is also activity going on with the mental activity.

There's bodily activity. And we even use the ideas of grasping and different types of bodily movements. We have a front and a back and we project that onto various things like trees or what have you.

And those trees don't have front or back without us projecting that onto the tree. It's part of our interaction with each other in relation to other things. And so you can imagine somebody who gets the wild notion that, well, hey, this thing called the state or the county, that's all just a construct of the mind.

And they put this darn ticket in my windshield wiper and just throw it in the street. And I do that enough times and pretty soon I have a boot on the car, right? And well, that's just a construct.

But I got to somehow or other get this boot off. Now I'm confronted with the pain and pleasure aspect of all of it. And sometimes it's deadly force.

It's lethal force that's backing it all. So I think that at all times it's potentially that lethal force. That's the most extreme measure.

But maybe I just have to go pay those damn tickets so I can get my car out from under domination and be free to travel within the overall society, which is all these things that we're discussing. So there are so many aspects to it all. You have to spend some time grappling with all these details in order to come to terms with it.

But what does that mean overall in terms of a human existence? Because people say, oh, well, we live in a free society. Well, what aspect of it is free?

I'm sitting here freely entering into a conversation with you. We're doing all these things to come up with these ideas and have great conversations regularly. That's all great.

We're free to do those things. But it's within a context and it's the context of domination that I'm interested in. And those of us that are descendants of people's ancestors who were classified as barbarians not that long ago within the society and the mental world of the Christian Europeans, our ancestors were barbarians.

That's different from some people that think of their ancestors and they don't have any of that history associated with their ancestors. So then what does that mean? What's the significance of that?

Well, barbarian means either non-human, like bestias, a beast in Spanish, or partially human. And there must be a process by which our ancestors who were classified in that way could become human. So as I began to work this all out, I thought, well, what are those steps of becoming human?

Well, you have to be robbed of your freeway of life. You have to be put under the control of the people coming in on top of you. You have to be baptized and given a Christian name.

And then in the case of California, you have the mission Indians being forced to toil and engage in horrific labor to build these massive mission structures. So that torment and misery and suffering that they're being subjected to is part of the process of making them human. And it's only after they've been able to successfully survive all that craziness, because massive numbers of them did not survive the brutality of the humanizing process, because that's what it was being used for, is to humanize them.

I used to say dehumanize, but now I'm rethinking all that. But at the other end of that, now you can become a human. But doesn't that suggest, then, that what we're calling a free society is actually the opposite of that?

[Peter] (27:31 - 30:19)

Yeah. I have a t-shirt. I could probably share the screen and show a picture that I took of it once.

But it has in big words, it says, land of the free. And then like advertising down in small print, it says, some restrictions apply. Void where prohibited.

And that's the notion of the state. It's essentially the notion of the United Nations document, the Declaration of Human Rights, is that this is all subject to restriction and void where prohibited. And one more thing, just to circle back around your notion of how natives became human in your story, so the humanization process, is that the document says that everyone has a right to personhood, basically.

Well, if we take person as the word mask, its root word in Greek, mask, it means everyone has a right to a mask, to an identity card, let's say, to a number, a citizenship number. So this is all just a gigantic operation that says you don't exist if you haven't been recognized. And so it's only a half step to go back to saying the native peoples that were here, they don't exist unless they've been recognized.

And that's still US law today. They don't exist as a people unless they have been recognized, quote unquote, by the state apparatus. And that, in turn, traces back to things that we don't have to go over again, but you've talked about them, the ceremonies of possession, the claim of right of domination that was enacted right when the sailors got off the ship and put their implements in the soil and said certain chanting prayer type declarations, that they were enacting a certain kind of magic act.

They were going through a play. There were the script that they had to follow. And at the end of that script, then, supposedly, reality had been created.

And my son, Adrian, was recently sharing some thoughts with me. He said in a kind of a little formula, he said, perception plus participation creates reality. And I thought that was really striking to me.

Perception means ideas, things we perceive. Plus our behavior, our participation is what creates reality. So it goes back to the idea of Shakespeare and his plays.

We have the perceptions, we have the participation, and suddenly we have the play. Now, the play could be Shakespeare's play on the stage, but the play could be in the king's chamber where the duke comes in and has to go down on one knee to acknowledge. You're right, I'm just a duke.

And then, go ahead.

[Steve] (30:20 - 30:26)

Well, I just wanted to say, and in the king's court, so that term court is another aspect.

[Peter] (30:26 - 32:36)

Yes, exactly. And I think that when we play around with these things, we get more out of them than when we try to be sort of academic. If we're looking at the documents academically, we see this kind of morass and so then we say, well, how do we get out of the morass?

I think we have to play this way. We have to play, and I guess unintentionally I'm making a pun here. We're playing with the fact that it's all a play and that the duke, I'm just a duke.

Now, if we go back to the right to resist tyranny, there's actually also a feudal origin of that. So there was the notion of liege lord, the duke's liege lord was the king. The duke was the liege man of the king.

And that went all the way down the chain to the peasants, who were liege men of the lowest of the lords. And all of that, since it was all personal, the notion of personal allegiance, all of that had a certain contractual element, like an agreement here, that the king had an obligation to protect his liege subjects. And if he didn't protect them, if he subjected them to tyranny, if he failed to make them secure, they had a right to rebel.

They had a right to resist because the king had broken the contract. And so that's where the UN document, it has certain tentacles that go back into that, but it's completely lost the notion that there's actually a right to rebel. That's what got eliminated from the first draft, there isn't that anymore.

Now it's that if the barons and the dukes and the counts say the king is abusing his position, he's not protecting us, he's subjecting us to tyranny, what is their recourse? Well, they better go to the court of exchequer, or the king's bench, or the court of common pleas. And the king has graciously provided ways for them to present their complaint.

[Steve] (32:36 - 32:38)

Yep, through petition and all that.

[Peter] (32:40 - 33:13)

Or the pleading, right? Yeah, exactly. And you have a prayer for relief, actually.

The very religious roots of it that we haven't touched on today, but we've touched on so many times, where the king is by divine right, so it was no accident that the way the whole court

system worked is you had pleadings, you were pleading and asking, and it was formally called your prayer, your prayer for relief. And that still exists today. If you look at any U.S. case and you look at the briefs that are filed, they have a prayer for relief.

[Steve] (33:14 - 33:42)

Yeah, yeah. Well, and also the L-E-I-G-E, liege, but also L-I-G-A and L-E-G-A, the term allegiance has that word, that lettering in there. It's embedded, okay, or ligament.

Yeah. It's a binding. It means to bind.

[Peter] (33:43 - 33:43)

Yeah, yeah.

[Steve] (33:43 - 35:55)

So what creates the binding? The oath. Yeah.

So you take the oath to the Lord, and in a sense, the Lord has taken an oath to you as a protector, and that's how that gets established. But then now you have that obligation, and there's L-I-G-A in the word obligation, liege, that's the binding of the relationship because it's been a pledge made to each other. Okay.

Yeah. Now, what's interesting, the way English works is to keep the domination out of the picture. I don't know how it does that or why it works that way.

But there are all kinds of phrases that don't acknowledge the domination, but domination is being alluded to or referenced. So oppression and tyranny, tyranny and oppression, slavery, servitude, all kinds of terms, they're synonyms for domination, but they're also euphemisms because they're not saying the word domination. So they're a bit softer in the way that they hit the mind and the way we, the connotation that we give to them, the way we interpret them.

And so that's a factor as well. And then the state, the complete phrase is the state of domination. If you're going to acknowledge that it's a domination system, because it stops short of that, and it only says the state, okay, the whole domination dimension of it is out of focus.

And the whole language seems to operate that way with nobody doing that. Nobody's making a point that, well, you have to do it this way. It's just automatic.

So how did that get created? The language operates in a way that keeps the domination out of focus. And what we're doing is bringing that into focus, but that's unusual.

And a lot of people feel very uncomfortable with that because domination is probably one of the most, if not the most negative term in English. Right?

[Peter] (35:55 - 36:52)

Yeah. And I think that people are uncomfortable because we're so far down the historical road into this framework that what are the alternatives? I mean, if we don't have obligation

to the state, et cetera, and we don't have authorized tribunals, what do we have?

Well, the simple answer is the alternative is like community or mutual feeling, mutual solidarity, things that are considered to be just woo-woo ideas, really, at this point. So nobody's saying the state is a woo-woo idea. Nobody's saying that.

Well, I shouldn't say nobody. There probably are some people saying it, but we live in a woo-woo world, and we think that the other world is woo-woo. And so we're lost.

And so we just better follow orders. That's probably the safest thing. When you get that little piece of paper under the windshield, just do what it says, suck it up, and deal with it.

[Steve] (36:52 - 38:33)

Under the windshield wiper. Yeah. So what's fascinating also is that the human rights discussion takes the space of what could be a discussion about domination, but that space is already preoccupied with this other terminology.

Because that's the premise. Now, all of the terminology is around human rights. Well, that's a human rights violation.

Their human rights are being violated. All the carnage and death and destruction. Yeah, that's horrible human rights violations.

Well, so the way, the disconnection of that euphemistic terminology from the reality of the massive death and destruction and carnage and all those other terms that we can use to describe what's actually going on on the ground is really helpful to the state. The one that's committing those crimes and so forth. But actually, are they really crimes?

Because that gets you into the whole international arena. And it's state against state. And no state can dictate to another state because they're equally systems of domination.

And there's all of that aspect and dimension to the overall discussion that could be taking place. But usually the domination terminology is not used unless they attach racial to it. It's racial domination.

It's ethnic domination. Well, maybe it's just domination, period, without any of those modifiers or adjectives.

[Peter] (38:33 - 38:51)

And it's gotten to the point where there's, I think, wasn't it Clinton when he attacked in the Balkans, it was for human rights reasons? Yeah. You can exercise violence in the name of protecting human rights.

It's a humanitarian mission. There you go. Humanitarian.

Yeah.

[Steve] (38:52 - 40:21)

Yeah. Is humanitarian similar to the humanizing aspect of domination, right? Yeah.

In making people, well, one thing I want to back up for a moment. So, isn't it interesting that the two departments of the Vatican, the Holy See, that made their statement about the doctrine of discovery, one of those two was the Dicastery, meaning Department of Integral Human Development, a framework of the Vatican. So, there's still that idea, oh, they're humanizing.

But earlier terminology, I have a book. I don't have it right here, but one of the books on the California mission system, and there was an agreement between the Dominicans and the Franciscans when they were coming into what's now called Southern California without the US-Mexican border. But generations ago, and their preoccupation, what they were really focused on was the spiritual conquest of the infidels.

Now, they dropped all that terminology. That terminology has to go away. That's a bygone era when we used to speak openly about such things.

Now, we're into the integral human development because it sounds so nice and positive. But it's all part of that domination agenda in some sense or other, right?

[Peter] (40:21 - 40:48)

Yes. As a matter of fact, that Dicastery that you're talking about, Integral Human Development, is within the, I don't remember the Vatican name, but the higher level is the Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith or something of that sort, and which was the renaming of the Inquisition. Okay?

So, the Integral Human Development, if you trace it through its origins and history in the Vatican infrastructure, is part of the Inquisition.

[Steve] (40:49 - 40:57)

Which is the question, Inquisition to inquire, to question. Yeah, yeah.

[Peter] (40:57 - 43:00)

And about whether there's heresy or not. That's right. Inquisition.

Faith and loyalty and obedience. Exactly. And speaking of faith and loyalty and so on, to go back to this Calvin thing, so legions is also, is considered an aspect of faith.

You have faith to your Lord, all right? And I already read the part about that it's a quality of the mind. It's not in any particular place.

And the court says that the idea that there would be local legions, in other words, a community, I could use that word, or at least a smaller group than, you know, the whole crown, it says that local legions is utterly insufficient. And the quality of natural legions is what they say binds the subjects to the king. They say that the binding of, you talked about ligature, the binding of the subjects to the kings is part of natural law, cannot be changed, is eternal.

And that local legions is associations among people because of their local existence together. That's not the same. And it must be overridden by this natural legions to the king.

So all of these things are part of, in a sense, if you go back to the Calvin's case, 1608, as you said a minute ago, there were times when we can see these were openly discussed, the Dominicans and the Jesuits and so on. And, you know, the predecessors that were willing to use a language that today people say, oh, we can't say that. But these were openly talked about, these ideas, and they were understood as being ideas.

And the question was, what will the power of the crown be used to enforce here? So which ideas will be coupled with force? Yeah.

Which ideas will not be coupled with official force? That's what these debates are about.

[Steve] (43:00 - 45:06)

And also the way in which the infidels are in a separate classification. They're outside the body of Christ. So all baptized people are part of the body of Christ using metaphors again for the body and things that are constructs of the human mind.

But they sound like they're talking about a physical reality. But the people that are not part of the body of Christ are outside the faith, right? And they're perpetual enemies of the crown, because they're perpetual enemies of the Christian world.

So the people that those of us who can think of our ancestors as having been on the infidel at the end of the spectrum, the infidel end of the spectrum, we have a totally different, potentially at least, different orientation toward all of this information in terms of trying to come to terms with what are we really looking at? Because if you're looking at it from inside the system of domination, as we call it, they don't think of it as a system of domination. They're in the Christian world, which is this beautiful thing.

It's called order. They say it's order. Well, that's something.

Anarchy has to be overcome by order. You don't have this order that we're bringing in rightfully and justly by means of force, which is the application of force for such a good cause is a virtuous enterprise, right? Yeah.

And so then those of us on our ancestors were on the receiving end of all that. And we're coming at it from a different vantage point, that view from the shore vantage point, looking out of the ship, coming toward our ancestors. And I think that contrast between those perspectives is so crucial to this work and this effort.

[Peter] (45:06 - 45:31)

Yes, yes. Another line from Calvin, by the way, you talked about faith. They're talking about how somebody becomes a subject of the king, is that they were born under the obedience, power, faith, legality, or allegiance of the king.

So there's faith is built right in there. Fides says that allegiance is sometimes called faith.

[Steve] (45:32 - 46:00)

And going back to the sentence from the papal bull, the thing from May 4, 1493, we have confidence in him, meaning faith in him, capital H on him, so that's the deity, from whom

empires and dominations and all good things proceed. So that's on the idea, in the idea realm, on the level of the religious order of things that manifests in the physical realm.

[Peter] (46:00 - 46:04)

Yeah. And confidence, literally, the Latin root *confiti*, with faith.

[Steve] (46:05 - 46:54)

Yeah, yeah, that's right. So that's, exactly. And so I hadn't even noticed that.

So the use of all these terminologies, the usual and accustomed approach is just to stay on a surface level. I created a new acronym, Surface Level Thinking Syndrome. It's just playing around, you know, the concept of play.

The playfulness of English, I think, is helpful when we do such exercises. What's kind of a playful way in which I can approach this to create a little bit of a humor, humorous aspect to it?

[Peter] (46:55 - 48:04)

Yeah, I like that a lot. I'm glad you said that because it seems to me one of the, we talked a few minutes ago about people not being sure what to do with this, is that there's a certain confusion and fear, what else do we have but the state to keep our lives in order, etc. And if we have this conversation and we come across as like, oh, we're here, we're rock throwers, we're going to upset things, we're just going to destroy things, that's not helpful.

And what is helpful is to be playful about it. It's like speaking in such a way that people look around and say, wow, I am in a hall of mirrors. I didn't realize that.

How did I get here? Oh, I'm in a funhouse. Well, the funhouse is usually kind of scary in a way, but how did I get here?

Where's the exit, right? And the exits are, it's like in a casino, the exits are hidden. You're not supposed to be, you're supposed to be entertaining yourself inside this system.

And you're not supposed to be entertaining yourself by thinking of, I'd rather be outside. I'd rather be somewhere else. I'm not even sure where there is outside, but I think there must be an outside.

[Steve] (48:05 - 48:14)

Yeah. Well, in the casino, they remove, there's no clocks, there's no sense of time because they want time to be suspended.

[Peter] (48:14 - 48:14)

Yeah.

[Steve] (48:14 - 51:03)

So they get caught up in the flow. There was a great line in the movie, we don't want them thinking, we want them buying. Yeah, yeah.

That kind of thing. But I came across this paper that I wrote all the way back in 2004 for the third annual tribal college forum. And Chet Bowers, my wonderful professor, C.A. Bowers had invited, I don't know if it was him. I think that was maybe a different event that I went to with him. But anyway, let's not get distracted with that. But the title of the paper, An Indigenous View of the Right of Discovery, Maps, Lines, and Arrogations.

So when people arrogate unto themselves, they're assuming in an arrogant manner, a particular series of attributes or number of attributes and so forth, you know. But there's this great line in here that, and this has to do with the use of space, time, matter, and number being used as a weapon system against original nations and peoples for the purpose of domination. And this is a quote from Jedediah Morse, who was a reverend, I forget what kind of minister he was, but he was very prominent.

And he created a survey of Indian affairs that was delivered to the Secretary of War in 1821 or 1822. But this is something that he wrote in the American Geography, published in 1789, the same year as the current Constitution was put into place. We cannot but anticipate the period not far distant when the American Empire, all in capital letters, will comprehend millions of souls west of the Mississippi.

Judging upon probable grounds, the Mississippi was never designed as the western boundary of the American Empire. And may we not venture to predict that when the rights of mankind shall be more fully known, and the knowledge of them is fast increasing, both in Europe and America, the power of European potentates will be confined to Europe, and their present American dominions become, like the United States, free, sovereign, and independent empires." Yep.

Isn't that a great...

[Peter] (51:03 - 51:13)

Yeah, yeah. Again, the plainness of the language, I guess. Yeah.

Yeah.

[Steve] (51:16 - 51:50)

And so the point I'm trying to make here is that along with the idea of the state of domination in brackets, and everything that we've been discussing today, maps are a central focus of the existence of what's called the state. Because it is a construct of the mind, they want to give the impression that it has a physical location. You were using the Latin term for where.

That implies a physical location.

[Peter] (51:50 - 51:51)

Yeah.

[Steve] (51:51 - 52:59)

But there's a way in which the mental location is identified by means of maps. That great line by S.I. Hayakawa, and I think there's another thinker before him, the map is not the territory. Okay, it's not the physical place, it's a depiction of the physical place.

But it's, again, all part of the mental construction of a reality that through participation, through behavior, through actions, and so forth, in interaction with each other, and along with all these beliefs, and faiths, and confidences, and on and on, all these different ideas, it makes it seem as if there is a physical location. I mean, I'm sitting in a chair in a physical location, I have the sense of a very definite place with an address attached to it on the street, and all that. That's all part of what has actually emerged from the human mind and along with human behavior to create this reality system.

[Peter] (53:00 - 53:20)

Yeah. Well, we're getting close to the top of the hour, I'm going to toss something else your way, that just to say, well, what is maybe, you know, it's really important, even though Peter and Steve are kind of tearing it to shreds, it's a really important document. Okay, here's Article 19.

Now, this is the final draft, this is not the final draft.

[Steve] (53:20 - 53:22)

Of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

[Peter] (53:22 - 55:09)

Yes, exactly. Everyone has the right to freedom of opinion and expression. This right includes freedom to hold opinions without interference and to seek, receive, and impart information and ideas through any media and regardless of frontiers.

Now, anybody that's older than, what, how old do you have to be to remember four years back when anybody that said anything that did not fit the narrative of the COVID so-called plan, they were blocked, they were censored, they were fired, they were not allowed to express those opinions. So it was violated, the Universal Declaration was violated. But, oh, if we go to Article 29, it says that in the exercise of rights and freedoms, everyone shall be subject, and then here's one of the weasel words, shall be subject only to such limitations, so you get rid of the word only, to such limitations as are determined by law solely for the purpose of securing due recognition and respect for the rights and freedoms of others and of meeting the just requirements of morality, public order, and the general welfare. Oh, so in other words, I have a right to say whatever I want to say on any media anywhere.

Oh, but unless the state has said that I don't. So we're back to land of the free. Some restrictions apply.

Void war prohibited. And so you come up to, I want to circle back and let you say something more about the humanization. Dehumanization is that people think that the Declaration of Human Rights is to prevent dehumanization, but in a sense it's to insist on humanization as defined by the system of domination.

[Steve] (55:10 - 56:02)

You know, it's really interesting, as I'm sitting here right at this moment, to think, okay, so maybe the dehumanization is the initial projection of these ideas of heathen, pagan, infidel, unbaptized persons, all these projections onto our ancestors. That's the dehumanization aspect. Then the humanizing process to make them human is all the things that I talked about already, the processes or steps necessary to force them under the domination system.

Now they're humans, and those of us that are the descendants of our barbarian ancestors, quote unquote, we are now considered to be in the human side of the equation because we're now living under domination as their descendants.

[Peter] (56:03 - 56:14)

Yeah, yes. And keeping in mind that all of this was going on for thousands of years within the domination societies before they even knew that there was another part of the world to go dominate.

[Steve] (56:14 - 56:36)

Yeah, well, the question I want to ask, to follow up on that, the idea that our ancestors still had the right to retain their free and independent existence despite this other trajectory of all these powers coming in on top of them, that's to me still the central focus.

[Peter] (56:36 - 56:37)

Yes.

[Steve] (56:37 - 56:53)

We still have a right to a free existence, is my contention, and the claim of a right of domination is not actually a right. It's something that's made that everybody's conditioned to believe that's a right because we're supposed to just cave to that.

[Peter] (56:54 - 58:03)

Because it's a claim. It's only a claim. It's a claim.

And I guess I agree with you. What I see, though, is that by focusing so carefully on the recent history, the last few hundred years on this continent, we open a door to look at the same situation on the other continent, which is that the peoples of—name all the countries you want in Europe and so on and so forth—the peoples were just like the peoples on this continent, living free and independent of the claim of a right of domination from Rome.

And that claim was made manifest not just in words, but it was made manifest in brutal acts, just as brutal as the Jesuits and the Dominicans. Maybe even more brutal in some cases, because people were burned alive at the stake for not having faith. They didn't have the faith.

They were heretics. They were infidels. And what was that faith?

They did not recognize the claim of the right of domination of Constantine and the Bishop of Rome. That's what they didn't recognize.

[Steve] (58:04 - 58:41)

And we should always keep in mind that the people being burned at the stake, there was a property dimension to all of that. The property of the heretic went to the church and to the state. And even if you were tortured, your estate had to pay for the torturer.

You can't just be tortured for free. There's a cost involved. The guy's drawing a salary as a torturer, right?

Or a team of torturers, a team of people that burn people at the stake. So, there's a cost involved, and they're going to extract that from your estate. It's bizarre when you think about it.

[Peter] (58:41 - 58:45)

Yeah, well, maybe we leave it at that point today. Is that good?

[Steve] (58:46 - 58:48)

Yeah, well, what a great conversation.

[Peter] (58:48 - 59:12)

Yeah, likewise. I like the way we segue so, you know, widely and yet, I think, pretty carefully among these different historical eras and moments and documents and so on and so forth. And as you said a minute ago, playing with them, hoping to illuminate something about the play that's being enacted.

[Steve]

Yeah, yeah. Beautiful.

All right, later.